

Recommended Formats for Local Online CCL 2027 Tournaments

Purpose of This Document

These recommendations are intended to help associations choose a format for their local online championship or qualifier based on:

- the number of participants, from approximately 4 to 50;
- the time available before the CCL 2027 Qualification Stage begins;
- the desired balance between speed, simplicity, and competitive fairness.

This is not an exhaustive list of permitted formats. An association may propose another transparent format, provided that it meets the CCL requirements and clearly explains in advance how the available places will be awarded.

If the final ranking gives an association places only in the Qualification Stage, it is not required to hold a local tournament to nominate those players. However, the association may still use one of the suggested formats as a transparent selection method.

Basic Requirements and Assumptions

Selection Requirements

- Direct places in the **CCL Main Stage** must be awarded based on the results of a local **online championship or online qualifier**.
- Matches that directly determine who receives a place in the Main Stage must be played as **Bo3 or Bo5**:
 - in a Single Elimination tournament, this applies at least to the semifinals and final;
 - if a tournament consists of a single Round Robin or Swiss stage, all matches must be played as at least **Bo3**.
- For places in the **CCL Qualification Stage**, an association may use another transparent selection method; the places do not have to be awarded based on the results of a single local tournament.
- Results from an **in-person** national tournament cannot be used to award direct places in the Main Stage, but they may be taken into account when selecting players for the Qualification Stage.

Important Note on Deadlines

If an association wants to hold a full online championship that will determine who receives direct places in the Main Stage, the effective deadline for completing that tournament is the end of the year. Player registration for the Main Stage closes on **December 30, 2026**.

In this case, the association may select its players for the CCL Qualification Stage without considering the results of the online championship. A player registered for the CCL Qualification Stage cannot later receive a direct place in the Main Stage based on the results of the national online championship, even if that player wins it. The direct place would then pass to the next eligible player, such as the runner-up or the third-place finisher.

Local Online Tournament Formats

Tournaments with One Round per Week

- Each player plays one match during every weekly round.
- All matches are played as **Bo3 or Bo5**.
- The durations in the table do not include player registration, the draw, or contingency time for rescheduled matches.

Estimated Duration

Format	4-8 players	9-16 players	17-32 players	33-64 players	65-128 players
Groups of 4: Round Robin + Single Elimination	5	6	7	8	9
Groups of 6: Round Robin + Single Elimination	-	8	9	10	11
Groups of 8: Round Robin + Single Elimination	-	10	11	12	13
Single Elimination	2-3	4	5	6	7
Double Elimination	4-7	8-9	10-11	12-13	14-15
Swiss Bo3 without playoffs	3	4	5	6	7
Round Robin Bo3 without playoffs	3-7	9-15	-	-	-

All values in the table are **numbers of weeks**.

For Double Elimination, the upper end of each range includes a possible bracket-reset grand final. If the rules provide for only one grand final, the tournament will finish one week earlier.

For Swiss, the table uses the basic number of rounds: 3, 4, 5, 6, or 7, depending on the number of participants. Each additional round adds one week.

Default Recommendation

- **4-7 participants:** one Round Robin, with all matches played as Bo3;
- **8-32 participants:** group stage followed by playoffs;
- **33-50 participants:** Single Elimination.

Brief Description of Each Format

Round Robin Groups + Single Elimination

In the first stage, participants play a Round Robin within their groups. After the group stage, the highest-ranked players advance to a Single Elimination playoff. The listed group sizes of 4, 6, or 8 players are a baseline; some groups may contain fewer players.

Groups of 4. A four-player group stage lasts three weeks. Usually, the top two players from each group advance to the playoffs. The total duration depends on the number of groups and the size of the playoff bracket.

Example: [German Carcassonne Online Championship 2025 - 8 players](#).

Groups of 6. A six-player group stage lasts five weeks. Usually, the top three players from each group advance to the playoffs.

Example: [Brazilian Online Championship 2026 - 48 players](#).

Groups of 8. An eight-player group stage lasts seven weeks. Usually, the top four players from each group advance to the playoffs.

Example: [Taiwan Carcassonne Online Championship 2025 - 16 players](#).

Single Elimination

A player is eliminated from the tournament after one loss. This is the shortest format: determining a winner requires between two and seven rounds, depending on the number of participants. If the number of participants is not a power of two, some players receive a first-round bye.

Example: [Clasificatorio Champions Chile 2025 - 72 players](#).

Double Elimination

A player is eliminated only after a second loss. The tournament has a winners' bracket and a losers' bracket, so it takes almost twice as long as Single Elimination. The rules must state in advance whether a bracket-reset grand final is required if the player from the losers' bracket wins the first grand-final match.

Example: [Romanian Carcassonne Online Championship 2025 - 10 players](#).

Swiss Bo3 without Playoffs

Before the draw, players are divided into pots. Pairings are made between players from different pots and determined for all rounds at once, so the full schedule is known before the tournament begins. No one is eliminated, and all participants play the same number of matches. The number of rounds is also determined in advance; the table above uses a baseline of three to seven rounds.

Example: [RCP Champions League 2025 - 18 players](#).

Round Robin Bo3 without Playoffs

Every participant plays every other participant. With an even number of players, the tournament lasts **N - 1** weeks; with an odd number, it lasts **N** weeks because one player has a bye in each round. This format should be used only for tournaments with **no more than 16 participants**; with more players, it is no longer practical because it takes too long.

Example: [Czech Online National Championship 2025 - 12 players](#).

Fast Tournaments: 1-2 Weeks

In these fast formats, the first stage is played as **Bo1**, while the playoffs are played as **Bo3**.

One Weekend: Swiss on Saturday + Playoffs on Sunday

- **Saturday:** an automated real-time Swiss tournament on BGA, played as Bo1.
- **Sunday:** a Single Elimination playoff, played as Bo3.
- **Total duration:** 2 days.

Example: [US National Carcassonne Championship 2026](#) - six Swiss rounds on Saturday followed by a top-eight playoff on Sunday.

Four Swiss Tournaments + Playoffs

- **First stage:** four separate automated real-time Swiss tournaments on BGA, played as Bo1 over four days.
- **Second stage:** a Single Elimination playoff, played as Bo3, with two days allowed for each round.
- **Total duration:** 10 days - 4 days for the Swiss tournaments and 6 days for three playoff rounds.

Example: [Portuguese CCL Qualifier 2025](#) - the top two players from each Swiss tournament formed the top-eight playoff field.

CCL 2027 Calendar Guidance

Player registration for the CCL 2027 Qualification Stage closes on **November 11, 2026**. If the local tournament will also determine the association's Qualification Stage players, we recommend completing it by **November 8** at the latest, leaving a few days to confirm the results and register the players.

If the Qualification Stage players are selected separately, the local online championship may run until the end of the year and determine only the direct places in the Main Stage. Registration for the Main Stage closes on **December 30, 2026**, so we recommend completing such a championship by **December 27** at the latest.

Format duration	Start date to finish by November 8
3 weeks	October 19
4 weeks	October 12
5 weeks	October 5
6 weeks	September 28
7 weeks	September 21
8 weeks	September 14
9 weeks	September 7
10 weeks	August 31